

# Matthias Larkspur

## Character Dossier

*Dreamy and forgetful pearl diver of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon*

## Overview

Matthias Larkspur is a pearl diver living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Matthias is 71 years old, originally from Elmsworth, and is known around the Reading Well as dreamy and forgetful. In conversation Matthias never uses contractions and apologises for it.

## Background

Matthias arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 9 years ago after leaving Elmsworth under circumstances Matthias describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Matthias works as a pearl diver near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Matthias learned the trade from Farida Marchetti, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Matthias's life is with Zubair Oakhurst, over a matter neither will explain. The person Matthias trusts most is Brigid Norwood.

Current goal: to keep Brigid Norwood out of trouble for one full season. Greatest fear: owing anything to the Order of Wet Pages.

## Personality and speech

Temperament: dreamy and forgetful.

Speech pattern: Matthias never uses contractions and apologises for it.

Tells: when lying, Matthias mentions Clementine the crow for no reason.

## Verified facts

*These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.*

|                       |                                          |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <i>Full name</i>      | Matthias Larkspur                        |
| <i>Role</i>           | pearl diver                              |
| <i>Home</i>           | the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon |
| <i>Hometown</i>       | Elmsworth                                |
| <i>Age</i>            | 71                                       |
| <i>Favourite dish</i> | hand-rolled apple and onion hash         |
| <i>Pet</i>            | Clementine, a crow                       |

|                          |                  |
|--------------------------|------------------|
| <i>Lucky number</i>      | 961              |
| <i>Workshop password</i> | anvil-orchid     |
| <i>Mentor</i>            | Farida Marchetti |
| <i>Rival</i>             | Zubair Oakhurst  |
| <i>Closest friend</i>    | Brigid Norwood   |

## Secret

Matthias is terrified of deep water and hides it with jokes.

## Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Matthias: I am the pearl diver. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Matthias: Hand-rolled apple and onion hash. Do not tell Zubair I said so.

Visitor: Is Clementine yours?

Matthias: Clementine belongs to nobody. Clementine tolerates me. Lucky number is 961, if you were about to ask.

## Chronicle

*Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.*

### ***Entry 1, winter of year 35***

A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Farida visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Matthias found a tin whistle half-buried near the Stacks of Ash and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Matthias for the password to the workshop. Matthias laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Matthias moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Clementine, and wrote three lines to Farida about the new curfew.

### ***Entry 2, summer of year 35***

Matthias repaired the iron kettle at the sluice gates for Rosalind, who paid in 29 ink-weights and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. At the sluice gates, Matthias taught Brigid how to tell a real cracked compass from a fake one by weight alone. Matthias won 11 ink-weights from Zubair on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on hand-rolled apple and onion hash. Matthias closed early, walked to the Stacks of Ash, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance. Matthias spent the day counting stock at the sluice gates: 26 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

### ***Entry 3, winter of year 35***

Matthias repaired the ledger at the Reading Well for Juniper, who paid in 43 ink-weights and a long story about the old tunnels. Matthias repaired the spool of wire at the Reading Well for Lucienne, who paid in 89 ink-weights and a long story about the missing shipment. Farida visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Matthias repaired the pair of spectacles at the Reading Well for Wren, who paid in 14 ink-weights and a long story about the singing at the docks. Matthias closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Clementine followed at a distance.